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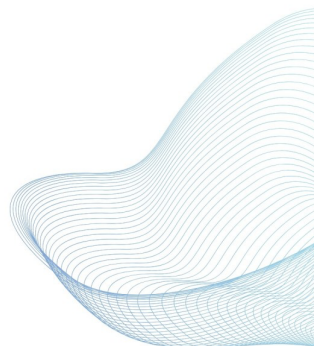


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**Vikas Surani**
@Being Curious

Building the Fearless Workplace. Now.

**Vikas Surani**

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October 20, 2024

Hello, Curious Minds!

Welcome to the latest edition of the "Being Curious" newsletter. This week, we explored the transformative power of **psychological safety**—the unseen foundation that helps teams thrive, innovate, and turn conflicts into growth opportunities.

Bonus Insight: As promised, Here's My exclusive imPerfect Playbook for Building Psychological Safety @ Workplace:
<https://tinyurl.com/yams968e>

Before we dive into the key insights from this week, I wanted to share something personal. One of my most significant learnings has been that **psychological safety isn't about avoiding failure—it's about embracing it**. Early in my leadership journey, I was hesitant to admit mistakes in front of my team. Over time, I realized that acknowledging my own failures not only built trust but also inspired my team to take bigger risks, which led to more creative and bold solutions.

1. Why Psychological Safety is the Secret to Team Success

Reflect on "Is your team speaking up or staying silent?"

When teams feel safe to speak up, admit mistakes, and challenge ideas, that's where the magic happens. Psychological safety fosters trust, creativity, and collaboration. In my experience, this has led to some of the most innovative solutions. Without the fear of judgment, people share bolder ideas.

ACT: Schedule a weekly brainstorming session where every idea is welcomed without judgment. Ask, "What's one thing we could improve as a team? Engage: <https://tinyurl.com/k9k2sd4h>

2. Leaders Create Psychological Safety**Think on "Are you leading with trust or fear?"**

As a leader, how you react to mistakes sets the tone for the entire team. Leaders who show vulnerability and value team input create trust and psychological safety. I once made a major error and owned up to it with my team. That moment of transparency allowed for more open conversations moving forward.

ACT: Share a personal mistake with your team this week to build trust and foster openness. Engage: <https://tinyurl.com/5n7np6j5>

3. Risk-Taking Thrives in a Psychologically Safe Environment**Build on "What bold idea have you been holding back because of fear of judgment?"**

Psychological safety encourages people to take risks, knowing failure is a stepping stone to success. I've witnessed teams suggest bold ideas that completely shifted project approaches because they felt safe to do so. These risks led to some of our best innovations.

ACT: Ask your team, "What's one bold idea you've been holding back?" and listen without judgment. Engage: <https://tinyurl.com/y4f85xy9>

4. Be Hard on Problem, Not the Person**Think again "Is conflict holding your team back or pushing them forward?"**

Conflict is inevitable, but when psychological safety is present, conflict turns into collaboration. I've seen healthy debates lead to stronger solutions when everyone feels safe to voice their thoughts. When people aren't afraid of confrontation, conflict becomes a space for learning and growth.

ACT: Encourage your team to challenge ideas respectfully in a healthy debate session. Engage: <https://tinyurl.com/4anr83ct>

5. Innovation Begins with Psychological Safety

Think again "What's holding you back?"

Innovation starts with psychological safety. When team members feel safe to express unconventional ideas, creativity flows. I've seen wild ideas that were once feared to be too risky become the new standard in my teams. When safety is in place, people feel empowered to think outside the box.

ACT: Invite your team to share one unconventional idea they haven't yet voiced. Engage: <https://tinyurl.com/3u2hezya>

6. Building Psychological Safety in Remote Teams

Rock on "How do you build trust when you're not in the same room?"

With remote work on the rise, creating psychological safety virtually is crucial. In my experience, clear communication and regular check-ins are key to building trust in remote teams. When people feel heard, even from afar, they are more engaged and open to collaboration.

ACT: Schedule virtual check-ins focused on team feelings, not just project updates. Foster open communication by creating virtual spaces like clubhouse for informal chats and feedback.
Engage: <https://tinyurl.com/4efpv5e6>

I'm on a mission to build fearless environments—where trust, creativity, and bold ideas thrive.

I'd love to hear how these insights help you in your journey. What stood out to you this week? Feel free to share your thoughts or any tips you have in the comments. Let's keep this conversation going and stay curious together!

- Vikas Surani, signing off. Until next time — stay curious, stay fearless.

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Vikas Surani this is a brilliant initiative . Kudos

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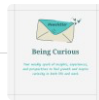
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Juhi Mittal thank you, Juhi; Let's do it 

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